

DRCS Engine — Quick Start

Get the engine running in under 5 minutes.

1. Clone & Install

```
git clone https://github.com/TellDontaMatter/drcs-engine.git
cd drcs-engine
npm install
```

2. Set Up Environment

Create `.env` file:

```
DATABASE_URL="file:./dev.db"
ABACUS_API_KEY="your-key-here" # Get from https://apps.abacus.ai/chatllm/admin/profile
PORT=3000
DRCS_TENANT="zilly"
```

3. Initialize Database

```
npx prisma generate
npx prisma migrate dev
npm run seed:zilly
```

What this does:

- Generates Prisma client
 - Creates SQLite database (`prisma/dev.db`)
 - Applies all migrations (AssetRegistry, CategorySchema, UsageLog, etc.)
 - Seeds Zilly tenant data (8 categories + canonical assets)
-

4. Run Tests

```
npm test
```

Expected output:

```
Test Suites: 10 passed, 10 total
Tests:       107 passed, 107 total
```

If all tests pass, the engine is working.

5. Try It Out

Web Console (Easiest)

```
npm run serve
# Opens at http://localhost:3000
```

Type a prompt:

```
make a hype post about hitting 10k followers
```

You'll get back:

```
{
  "decision": "PUBLISH",
  "file_path": "media/assets/zilly_mascot.png",
  "caption": "Victory",
  "source": "AS_IS"
}
```

CLI

```
npm run evaluate -- --prompt "create some chaos content"
```

Output:

```
DECISION: PUBLISH
FILE:      media/assets/zilly_06_jump_rope.png
CAPTION:   Chaos
SOURCE:    AS_IS
```

Programmatic (In Your Code)

```
import { evaluatePrompt } from 'dracs-engine';

const verdict = await evaluatePrompt('zilly', 'make a hype post');
console.log(verdict.file_path); // "media/assets/zilly_mascot.png"
console.log(verdict.caption);   // "Victory"
```

6. What Just Happened?

1. **Your prompt** → `evaluatePrompt()` entry point
2. **LLM extracted intent** → mapped “hype post about 10k followers” to category “Victory”
3. **C6 (Governance)** → disposition: PUBLISH
4. **C2 (Situational Bank)** → resolved category “Victory” → found asset `08_victory_jump`
5. **C4 (Resolution)** → exact caption match “Victory” → EXISTING_AS_IS
6. **C3 (Governor)** → usage count within 30-day window: 0/3 → allowed
7. **Content Retrieval** → `resolveAsset("08_victory_jump")` → `file_path` + caption
8. **Verdict returned** → `{ decision: "PUBLISH", file_path: "...", caption: "Victory" }`

Total latency: ~2 seconds (includes one LLM call for prompt extraction).

7. Explore the Docs

Document	What It Covers
<code>README.md</code>	Master index, gate status, architecture overview
<code>00-design-principles/vision-and-constraints.md</code>	Locked principles governing every design decision
<code>01-gates/*/</code>	Per-gate docs (purpose, contract, acceptance criteria)
<code>02-architecture/systems-ladder.md</code>	How the engine is built, layer by layer
<code>03-operating-rules/deployment-and-usage.md</code>	Deployment, API reference, multi-tenant config
<code>04-reference/handoff-capsule.md</code>	Multi-LLM continuity package (full project transfer)

8. Common Next Steps

Add a New Tenant

See `03-operating-rules/deployment-and-usage.md` → “Multi-Tenant Configuration”

Deploy to Production

See `03-operating-rules/deployment-and-usage.md` → “Production Checklist”

Understand a Specific Gate

See `01-gates/C*-*/` for detailed gate documentation

Modify the Prompt Extraction Logic

See `src/orchestrator/index.ts` → `extractPromptFields()`

Add Real Media Files

Update `src/seeds/zilly.ts` with actual file paths, re-run `npm run seed:zilly`

9. Troubleshooting

“LLM returned HTTP 401”

→ `ABACUS_API_KEY` missing or invalid. Check `.env`.

“No category matches situation X”

→ C2 couldn't resolve the category. Either seed it in `CategorySchema`, or the LLM picked a name that doesn't exist.

“file_path is null”

→ Asset exists but `file_path` not populated. Run `assetRegistry.updateFilePath(tenant_id, asset_id, path)` or re-seed with updated data.

“Tests fail with ‘Cannot find module @prisma/client’”

→ Run `npx prisma generate`.

10. Need Help?

- **Handoff Capsule:** `04-reference/handoff-capsule.md` (complete project context)
 - **API Reference:** `03-operating-rules/deployment-and-usage.md`
 - **Gate Contracts:** `01-gates/*/` (one folder per gate)
 - **GitHub Issues:** <https://github.com/TellDontAMatter/drcs-engine/issues>
-

You're now running the DRCS engine. Ship something.